that Kabul was well prepared to wait out a long siege. See Iqtidar Alam Khan, *The Political Biography of a Mughal Noble: Mun'im Khan Khan-i Khanan, 1497–1575* (Orient Longman, 1973). Decades later, Jahangir describes one of his generals throwing elaborate banquets on the turrets of his fort to befuddle the besieging force below.

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. Mahomed Kasim Ferishta, *History of the Rise of the Mahomedan Power in India till the Year A.D. 1612*, vol. 2, trans. John Briggs (R. Cambray & Co., 1909).

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Ibid.

. Ibid.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 3, trans. W.M. Thackston.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Ibid.

. Nizamuddin Ahmad, *Tabakat-i Akbari*.

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 3, trans. W.M. Thackston.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Ibid.

. For Abul Fazl, this second innings at Panipat occurred 'so that the conquest of Hindustan would take place all over again', this time under its rightful ruler, Akbar. But then, there are few setbacks in Mughal history that Abul Fazl won't describe as ordained for Akbar's greater glory; even the debilitating defeat at Kannauj was a merely 'unpleasant event' meant to 'ward off the evil eye' in anticipation of Akbar's birth. See Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vols 1 and 3, trans. W.M. Thackston.

. Gunpowder is the popular explanation for Babur's victory, but it is disputed. Stephen Dale, for example, writes that Ibrahim Lodi's defeat was mostly the work of Babur's Mongol cavalry, mounted archers sent to 'outflank and envelop the enemy'. Thus, writes Dale, 'This was not primarily a gunpowder victory, for Babur himself reports that his new artillery pieces fired only a "few shots". Firearms may have contributed to his triumph by helping to defend his center, but Mongol flanking attacks won the battle, as they had so many times before in Central Asia.' Stephen F. Dale, *The Muslim Empires of the Ottomans, Safavids, and Mughals* (Cambridge University Press, 2010).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Harbans Mukhia, *The Mughals of India*.

. As Hemu was wounded by accident, so he was arrested by chance. Nizamuddin writes that one Shah Kuli Khan saw Hawai wandering driverless, thought of taking the elephant, whom he did not recognize, and sent his mahout to mount it. 'The driver then perceived that there was a man lying wounded in the howda and upon examination this person proved to be Himun himself. Shah Kuli Khan, fully alive to the importance of his discovery, drove the elephant, along with several others which had been captured in the field, to the presence of the Emperor.'

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Akbar's eldest son, Salim, later Jahangir, relates this story in *The Jahangirnama: Memoirs of Jahangir, Emperor of India*, ed. and trans. W.M. Thackston (Oxford University Press with the Smithsonian Institution, 1999).

. The fief was Tardi Beg's, in fact, and its loss may well have accounted for his desire to leave Hindustan after the fall of Delhi.